2.6 Risk for Falls*

Assessment	Nursing Diagnosis	Plan / Expected Outcome	Nursing Interventions	Evaluation
Subjective • "I feel unsteady when I walk." **Objective** • Shuffling gait • Holds furniture to walk • Generalized weakness	**ACTUAL** Impaired walking ability related to muscle weakness as evidenced by an unsteady gait and need for support.	• Walks safely with an aid within 3 days.	• Observe her gait and balance. • Provide a walker or cane and show her how to use it. • Walk alongside her until she is steady. • Involve the physiotherapist.	• Considered met when she walks with the aid and keeps her balance.
Subjective • "I did not know I should call for help." **Objective** • Gets out of bed alone at night • Unaware that she is at risk of falling	**ACTUAL** Inadequate health knowledge related to fall prevention as evidenced by unsafe behavior and inaccurate statements.	• Patient and family name three fall-prevention measures within 24 hours.	• Explain why she is at risk and what the precautions are for. • Show her the call bell; teach her to rise slowly. • Ask the family to keep the floor clear. • Check understanding with teach-back.	• Goal reached when she calls for help before getting up.
Subjective • Dizzy on standing • Fell once in the past year **Objective** • Aged 75 • Taking an antihypertensive and a sedative • Nocturia	**RISK** Risk for adult falls as evidenced by risk factors: history of falls, advanced age, medications and nocturia.	• No falls during the admission.	• Score fall risk on admission and daily with a validated tool. • Keep the bed low and locked; use rails as policy allows. • Leave the call bell and her belongings within reach. • Provide non-slip footwear and a night light. • Offer the toilet every 2 hours and before she settles. • Check for orthostatic hypotension.	• Met if she does not fall during the stay. • After any fall, examine for injury and report as policy requires.

*References for this care plan: [35], [48], [51], [53], [110]. Full entries are listed in the References section of the CPMN book.